A New Doctor in the House

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/74035756.

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Glimmer (She-Ra) & Akrash (Defiance), Angella (She-Ra) & Akrash (Defiance)

Characters:
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by tp9829, Zelenal

Summary

Akrash, after having finished his training in healing magic at Mystacor, goes to Bright Moon Palace in order to start his new job.

Notes

Our first entry without Adora or any of the Halfmoon crew! It won't be the last, either, as we start setting the stage for canon events that this AU hasn't changed.

- Inspired by Defiance by TheNotebookWizard

The Gates of Bright Moon

Bright Moon Palace

Bright Moon

Etheria

Nine Years After the Coup Attempt

Standing in front of the gates to Bright Moon Palace, Akrash took a deep breath to try and settle his nerves. He failed, of course, but he still had to try. He knew he was being ridiculous—the job was already his; this was just a formality—but his nerves were still getting to him anyway. After all, this was it. After countless hours of training, studying, and therapy, he was finally about to become what he had always wanted to be.

(Well, *almost.* He was in the wrong place and surrounded by the wrong people but that was a dream he couldn't even *begin* to entertain.)

So distracted by his nerves was Akrash that he missed the tell-tale twinkling that heralded the arrival of a certain someone.

"Akrash! What's taking you so long?!" Glimmer complained as she appeared behind him.

Akrash let out a startled yowl as he jumped a solid foot into the air, his fur standing on end and his tail floofing out to three times its normal size. "Glimmer!" he shouted as he turned around, one hand clenched over his heart. "Don't… *do* that!" She had become an absolute *menace* to polite society once she had bonded with the MoonStone and gained the ability to teleport.

The fourteen-year-old Princess' grin was every bit as unapologetic as it was shit-eating. "Nope!" she said cheerfully.

"C'mon! Mom's already waiting for you!"

"Glimmer, wait—" Akrash began as Glimmer reached for him only for her to grab him and immediately teleport them away. Akrash squeezed his eyes shut in borderline fear as his ears pinned back and his tail lashed. When all he heard was Glimmer's amused laughter, he cautiously opened one eye to see that they were standing outside of the door to the throne room.

"Oh, thank the Stars Above," Akrash said as he visibly deflated. "I had been worried that you were about to teleport us into the throne room."

"Oh, please," Glimmer said as she shoved her cousin's shoulder. "As if I'd ruin this for you. Sure, the job's basically already yours but I know how much my mom loves her ceremonies," she said with a roll of her eyes.

"Indeed." Akrash straightened his robe and brought his tail around to smooth the fur on it flat. He turned to face the door and cleared his throat a couple times before straightening his already straight robes once more.

"You'll be *fine;* stop worrying so much," Glimmer said with a dismissive wave. "I'll see you inside!" And, with that, she disappeared in a shower of sparkles.

Akrash took one last deep breath to try (and fail) and steady his nerves before pushing open the doors.

Akrash's eyes locked onto Queen Angella sitting on her floating throne staff in hand on the far end of the throne room. She was smiling gently and welcomingly at him so that was a good sign. (Akrash knew that Glimmer was right; he *did* basically already have the job and this was just a formality but that didn't stop his nerves from eating him alive, even if he did little to show it.)

Glimmer was standing off to Queen Angella's right while General Juliet stood to her left. Glimmer was smiling happily at him and gave him a subtle thumbs up while mouthing "You've got

this." Juliet, meanwhile, had her usual resting bitch face that she wore when on duty (and about half the time when she was *off).*

Off to either side of the throne room stood a number of people who Akrash recognized as the various members of Queen Angella's court, including the current Royal Physician (whose job Akrash was gunning for; he was *absolutely* more skilled than its current holder).

Akrash could feel the ancient magics hanging heavily in the air calling out to him, encouraging him to cast aside all lies and speak only the truth. The first few times he had been in here, they had unnerved him and made his fur stand on end. Now, they *still* unnerved him but he didn't visibly react.

Akrash walked at a carefully controlled pace before coming to a stop in the middle of the circle inscribed on the floor in front of the floating steps. He placed both fists over his heart before bowing deeply, spreading his hands slightly as he did so.

"Greetings, Queen Angella of Bright Moon. I am Akrash of Mystacor, son of Castaspella of Mystacor, and I come to humbly beseech a request," he said the practiced words evenly.

"Rise, Akrash of Mystacor," Angella ordered. When Akrash did so, she continued. "Bright Moon welcomes you and all those seeking aid with open arms. Please, state your request and, should it be within my power and within reason, I shall have it granted."

"I ask that you take me under your employ as a physician in Bright Moon Palace. I have study for many years in Mystacor under the finest physicians there and have studied under another physician of great talent." Akrash dared not bring up Halfmoon and Lenio (Oh, how Akrash missed him and Halfmoon in general); Queen Angella wouldn't believe him even if he *did.*

"Your skills are known to me and to this court," Queen Angella continued. "Do any present object to the appointment of Akrash

of Mystacor to the role of physician of Bright Moon Palace?" When there were, predictably, no objections, Angella rose from her throne and slowly walked down the floating steps until she stood before him. "Before you are welcomed into these halls, do you swear to uphold the oaths of your office?"

"I swear."

"Do you swear to always act with the goal of the preservation of life and to never harm those who are sick or wounded unless forced to defend yourself or others?"

"I swear."

"Do you swear to treat any who may request your aid, regardless of their allegiances?"

"I swear." For this one, Akrash wasn't 100% certain if he was telling the truth. If Kellam and/or Varlaine were to show up asking to help heal them, he probably *wouldn't.*

"Then, Akrash of Mystacor, son of Castaspella of Mystacor, I, Queen Angella of Bright Moon, do hereby welcome you into our halls as one of our physicians," Angella finished with a smile.

"Woo!" Glimmer cheered as she teleported over to Akrash' side and wrapped him up in a fierce hug. After a moment of stunned disbelief, he returned it, a happy purr rumbling to life in his chest. "I *told you* that there was nothing to worry about!"

Akrash smiled down at Glimmer as he chuckled. He wished that his mother could have been here but she was busy dealing with certain matters back in Mystacor. "That you did." He then turned his attention to Queen Angella, who was warmly smiling down on the both of them. "So, Your Majesty, when do I begin?"

"You begin tomorrow," Queen Angella answered. "I take it that you still remember the way to your room?"

"Doesn't matter!" Glimmer interjected. "I'll take him there!"

"Glimmer, wait!" And then they were gone once more in a shower of sparkles.

Akrash's Office

Bright Moon Palace

Bright Moon

Etheria

Thirteen-and-a-Half Years After the Coup Attempt

Akrash, now the Royal Physician, sat in his office diligently chipping away at the mountain of paperwork he seemed to always have. It had been a *long* four years but pleasantly so, for the most part. He was more or less living his dream; he still got to regularly see his mother and his sister, Ariel; and Glimmer was fun to hang out with (not that he'd ever tell her that). He was treated with respect and dignity and well-liked by basically everyone. He had even managed to secure this position after being in Bright Moon for only a bit over a year!

Of course, even with all of that success, Akrash couldn't help but still miss Halfmoon and Lenio. How were they all doing? Were they standing strong against the Horde and all of those other peoples that harried them? Who had managed to survive the coup attempt? *Had* it just been an attempt or had it been successful? (Akrash prayed fervently that it had *just* been an attempt that at least Crown Princess Lyra survived.)

Was Lenio still alive after all of these years? Did he hate him or had he forgiven him in his absence?

There was no way to answer any of those questions at present so they were put aside. It's not like he would feel comfortable returning to Halfmoon without having someone or something with him to beg forgiveness, after all.

Akrash’s otherwise pleasant day was interrupted by the tell-tale sound of chimes that heralded the arrival of his favorite (and only) cousin. “What can I do for you, Glimmer?” he asked without looking up from his paperwork.

Glimmer slammed her hands on his desk, causing him to startle and look up at her. His plans for the day were immediately shelved by the deathly serious look on her face. “Akrash, I need your help!”

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